

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

TUESDAY, JULY 21, 2026

A \$10b glimpse at saving city from floods

Army Corps blueprint calls for levees and walls. Left unclear: Who will pay?

By Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF

A floodgate spanning Commercial Street in the North End. A 6-foot-tall flood wall along Blue Line tracks in East Boston. A waterfront walkway on top of a levee near the University of Massachusetts Boston in Dorchester.

Boston officials on Monday released a summary of a \$10 billion draft plan to build these and other defenses fortifying the city's 47 miles of coastline against flooding

and sea level rise. The US Army Corps of Engineers, which has spent four years developing the proposal, will issue a full report on the plan on Friday.

"Today marks a major milestone in Boston's fight to protect our city from climate change," said Mayor Michelle Wu at a news conference.

As Boston confronts an estimated more than four feet of sea level rise by the end of the century, the 20 proposed projects could offer a once-in-a-generation opportunity to

transform the waterfront. But with federal dollars in flux, and city and state budgets strapped for funds, the question of who will pay looms.

The Army Corps has been working on the study since 2022. It has similar proposals in the works around the country and anticipates presenting a final report to Congress in 2028. If the Boston projects are authorized, the federal government could cover as much as 65 percent of the cost. The city and state or other entities would have to pay for the rest.

Though the plan's price tag is steep, city officials said it pales in comparison to the cost of doing

nothing. The Army Corps estimates that Boston would face more than \$54 billion in losses between 2040 and 2090 if it does not act, including damage to critical infrastructure and businesses. Logan Airport, the Mass Pike, the MBTA, and hospitals are all vulnerable to flooding.

"This will be the largest investment in Boston's waterfront in generations," said Brian Swett, the city's chief climate officer, at a press event.

The Boston Green Ribbon Commission, a group of business and civic leaders helping Boston meet its climate goals, announced in June it had launched a project to develop a

FLOOD PLAN, Page A7

Family urges ICE agent be charged

Maine officials asked to investigate; administration scolded over hiring

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

The family of the Colombian immigrant shot and killed by an ICE officer in Maine said they want to see state officials bring criminal charges against the agent and condemned the Trump administration for giving a gun and a badge to an individual with a documented history of violent behavior.

Benjamin Gideon, an attorney representing the family of Johan Sebastián Durán Guerrero, the 25-year-old immigrant shot in his car in Biddford, Maine, last week, shared the strongly worded statement with The Boston Globe Monday, on behalf of himself and Durán Guerrero's relatives. The family said it is working with the state attorney general's office as it conducts a criminal investigation, with relatives meeting in-person Monday with the lead state detective on the case.

Martha Karolina Rojas Alvarez, Durán Guerrero's partner, will provide the attorney general's office with a release to search Durán Guerrero's car, Gideon said.

In addition to investigating the shooting itself, Gideon said the family and legal team wants state officials to "investigate how it is possible that a

INVESTIGATION, Page A10

Jackson quickly grabs support in Senate bid

Onetime Maine logger faces rugged path to oust Collins

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

Six weeks ago, on a glorious early summer Monday evening, Troy Jackson was flipping burgers.

As supporters gathered on the banks of the Penobscot River near Bangor for a thank-you cookout, Jackson — a former state Senate president from the far north Maine woods — was hoping to win the Democratic primary for governor the next day and then campaign through November with his close ally, Senate candidate Graham Platner.

What feels like multiple political lifetimes later, Jackson lost that primary, and Platner withdrew from his race in scandal. Now, Jackson will need to flip more than burgers: Democrats are moving to task him with flipping Maine — and possibly the whole US Senate.

Jackson quickly came forward to replace Platner, and his organizing muscle turned what was shaping up as a contentious process to pick a new candidate into a foregone conclusion. Over the weekend, when county parties met to select delegates to Saturday's statewide convention, they voted in overwhelming numbers for delegates who

SENATE, Page A10



PHOTOS BY CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Cyclospora-wary shoppers turn to farmers markets

Intestinal outbreak has consumers thinking local

By Lindsay Crudele
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

For health-minded grocery shoppers, the farmers market holds appeal. But lately, an uptick of cyclospora — a parasite found on fresh produce that can cause a chronic symptom notoriously referred to as "explosive diarrhea" — may be one more reason to shop local.

This week, the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention and the Food and Drug Administration said they continue to investigate a multistate outbreak that has hospitalized close to 150 people across 34 states, as of this week. Though there are far fewer cases in Massachusetts than elsewhere in the country — just 18 as of July 1 — shoppers remain wary. An initial report tying the outbreak to Mexican-grown lettuce from Taylor Farms was later determined to be a false positive, further complicating the matter of what's safe to eat.

That lack of clarity is what brought Brighton residents Fiona Noonan and Julia Joyce to the Brighton Farmer's Market last week as first-time visitors.

"We went to Trader Joe's earlier, and we were like, we probably

FARMERS MARKETS, Page A7



Brighton Farmer's Market was a popular place for grocery shoppers last week. Among the bounty were various root vegetables.



Drops, the boom

Tuesday: Scattered storms. High 78-83, low 69-74.

Wednesday: More storms. High 82-87, low 64-69.

High tide: 5:23, 5:48.

Sunrise: 5:26. Sunset: 8:15.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

VOL. 310, NO. 21

*

Suggested retail price
\$4.00



For breaking news, updated stories, and more, visit our website:

BostonGlobe.com



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

A SWING MOST SWEET

Sox fans such as Parker Rankin have had much to cheer about lately. As the din and dreams of the World Cup have faded, attention turns to the Olde Town Team. This band of little-knowns has strung together 14 straight wins. **C1.** A look at how that has turned Fenway around. **B1.**